

art

Shades of Grey

MUMBAI A plethora of issues find their way into 'Relics of Grey', an exhibition of photographs, objects, paintings and videos by Archana Hande. It comprises three large sculptural installations—White Town, Black Town and Grey Town. In White Town: Victoria House, Hande draws attention to the renaming of the Victoria Terminus (VT) station, a move, she feels, was to erase the significance of colonial architecture in India's cultural history. The façade—created by street-side billboard painters from around VT—showcases the plight of workers who are losing their livelihood due to digital print technology.

Through Grey Town, the artist evokes aspects of an earlier performance installation in which she played a Hindu woman who att-

empted to illegally claim a share of her adopted family's property. Issues of migration and displacement are addressed in the final section, Black Town.

Hande's project began as an investigation into the cultural, social and political attitudes of people who lived in India's port cities and commercial hubs. The journey started with childhood albums from her ancestral home and memories of her orthodox Brahmin family.

The three installations also include interesting snippets of interviews with people of varied ethnic backgrounds and their views of life and society. One shows a migrant Chinese hairdresser talk about styles in the 1960s; in another, members of a country club discuss the Raj leftover culture of luxury and exclusivity. On display at Chemould, Prescott Road till August 4.

by Aditi Pai

Hande's still-life creation, a woman in a red saree on steps



art

New Kids on the Block

DELHI They are set to catch 'em young and fresh. In the quest to discover new talent, India's first multinational art gallery, Bodhi Art, is showing works of the winners of its annual award for young art students instituted in collaboration with the Department of Fine Arts, M.S. University of Baroda. The winners of the Bodhi Art Award 2006 are Atul Mahajan (sculpture) and Navin Chahande (print making) though "not by any means gallery-ready" in the words of the jury. They have, nonetheless, been selected because of their capacity and clear potential for future development "even if not fully consolidated at this stage". While Chahande has been commended for his talent and ability to "harness varied graphic and digital media into his sculpture and installation", Mahajan has been selected for his skill for "revitalising sculpture by reference to interactivity and public-space behaviour, drawing the viewer into an awareness of labour, magic and the palpability of elements like air and movement". On view from July 5 to August 4 at Bodhi Art, Grand Mall, Mehrauli-Gurgaon Road, Gurgaon. A must see if you wish to know where young Indian art is heading.

by S. Kalidas

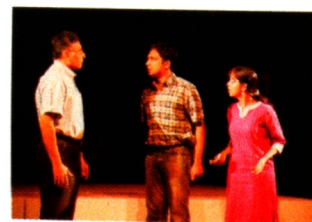
YOUNG ART: A print by Chahande



theatre

Slice of Life

CHENNAI After Bangalore, Five Point Someone, Madras Players' production presented by Evam, will come to the city on July 22 at the Music Academy at 7.30 p.m. Based on Chetan Bhagat's slice of life novel about three students and their myriad experiences at IIT, the play has been interestingly adapted and directed by Chennai-based



Exploring student romance young playwright Nikhila Kesavan. It explores youth, friendship and romance and promises pure, undiluted entertainment. The play will travel to Coimbatore, Mumbai, Delhi, Kolkata, Hyderabad and Pune.

by Akhila Krishnamurthy